

IMAT GK DRILL — 100 Questions

100 questions · 100 minutes · scoring: +1.5 correct, -0.4 wrong, 0 blank · GK drill

Section A - Reading Skills & Vocabulary in Context (Q1-8)

1. Read the following passage and answer the question.

For decades, adolescent risk-taking was attributed chiefly to ignorance: teenagers, the assumption went, simply failed to grasp how dangerous their behaviour was. Neuroimaging has complicated that picture. The limbic system, which processes reward, matures earlier than the prefrontal cortex, which supplies self-control, and the mismatch between the two is widest in mid-adolescence. Teenagers, it turns out, often appraise risks quite accurately; what sets them apart is that, especially under the gaze of peers, the anticipated reward looms larger than the anticipated harm.

Which of the following best captures the passage's main point?

- A)** Adolescents take risks because they cannot understand danger at all.
- B)** Uneven maturation of brain systems, rather than mere ignorance, helps explain adolescent risk-taking.
- C)** Neuroimaging has disproved the very existence of adolescent risk-taking.
- D)** Peer observation permanently damages the adolescent prefrontal cortex.
- E)** The prefrontal cortex matures before the limbic system in most adolescents.

2. For decades, adolescent risk-taking was attributed chiefly to ignorance: teenagers, the assumption went, simply failed to grasp how dangerous their behaviour was. Neuroimaging has complicated that picture. The limbic system, which processes reward, matures earlier than the prefrontal cortex, which supplies self-control, and the mismatch between the two is widest in mid-adolescence. Teenagers, it turns out, often appraise risks quite accurately; what sets them apart is that, especially under the gaze of peers, the anticipated reward looms larger than the anticipated harm.

In the passage, 'the anticipated reward looms larger than the anticipated harm' means that, for the adolescent, the reward:

- A)** persists longer in memory.
- B)** is approved of by peers.
- C)** is physically larger in size.
- D)** has been measured more precisely than the harm.
- E)** is felt to matter more than the harm.

3. Read the following passage and answer the question.

Some researchers argue that reflecting a fraction of sunlight before it reaches the Earth's surface — so-called solar radiation management — could cool the planet quickly and cheaply, buying time while emissions fall. Critics reply that the technique is a sedative, not a cure: it eases the symptom of warming, temperature, while leaving its cause, greenhouse gases, untouched. They add a further worry: were the programme ever stopped abruptly, decades of masked warming could surface within a few years.

Which statement is supported by the passage?

- A)** The technique eliminates the causes of climate change while ignoring its symptoms.
- B)** Solar radiation management removes greenhouse gases from the atmosphere.
- C)** Critics believe the programme could never be stopped for any reason.
- D)** Solar radiation management could lower temperatures faster than emission cuts alone.
- E)** All researchers agree the technique should be deployed immediately.

4. Some researchers argue that reflecting a fraction of sunlight before it reaches the Earth's surface — so-called solar radiation management — could cool the planet quickly and cheaply, buying time while emissions fall. Critics reply that the technique is a sedative, not a cure: it eases the symptom of warming, temperature, while leaving its cause, greenhouse gases, untouched. They add a further worry: were the programme ever stopped abruptly, decades of masked warming could surface within a few years.

The critics' phrase 'a sedative, not a cure' implies that solar radiation management:

- A)** is prohibited under international law.
- B)** has never been modelled by scientists.
- C)** relieves a symptom of warming without removing its cause.
- D)** costs more than conventional emission reductions.
- E)** is medically dangerous to the researchers themselves.

5. Read the following passage and answer the question.

Deep-learning systems now match or exceed specialists at reading certain retinal scans, and hospitals are eager to deploy them. Enthusiasm, however, can outrun evidence. An algorithm trained on patients from a handful of teaching hospitals may falter when it meets the cameras, the lighting and the patient mix of ordinary clinics. Its headline accuracy, measured on data that resemble its training set, is not guaranteed to travel. What a clinic needs is not a demonstration but a deployment study: performance measured where the machine will actually be used.

In the passage, 'is not guaranteed to travel' suggests that the algorithm's reported accuracy:

- A)** may fail to transfer to settings unlike those it was trained in.
- B)** depends on the price of the scanning equipment.
- C)** improves as more cameras are installed.
- D)** has been refuted by the specialists who trained it.
- E)** breaches patient-confidentiality rules across borders.

6. Deep-learning systems now match or exceed specialists at reading certain retinal scans, and hospitals are eager to deploy them. Enthusiasm, however, can outrun evidence. An algorithm trained on patients from a handful of teaching hospitals may falter when it meets the cameras, the lighting and the patient mix of ordinary clinics. Its headline accuracy, measured on data that resemble its training set, is not guaranteed to travel. What a clinic needs is not a demonstration but a deployment study: performance measured where the machine will actually be used.

Which of the following best expresses the author's central claim?

- A)** Algorithms should be trained exclusively in ordinary clinics.
- B)** Teaching hospitals systematically exaggerate scanner costs.
- C)** Retinal specialists will soon become redundant.
- D)** Deep learning has no useful role in ophthalmology.
- E)** Adoption should rest on performance validated in real deployment settings, not on headline benchmarks.

7. Read the following passage and answer the question.

The microbes of the human gut ferment dietary fibres that our own enzymes cannot break down, releasing short-chain fatty acids that feed the cells of the intestinal wall and help keep inflammation in check. A diet chronically poor in fibre therefore does more than deprive the body of roughage: it starves a metabolic partnership refined over millions of years. Deprived of fibre, some microbes turn to an alternative fare — the mucus that lines the gut — thinning the barrier that separates the microbial world from the body's own tissues.

Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A)** All gut microbes are harmful to human health.
- B)** Short-chain fatty acids are produced by human digestive enzymes.
- C)** Chronic fibre deficiency may weaken the barrier protecting gut tissues.
- D)** Mucus is the preferred food of all gut bacteria.
- E)** Inflammation is caused exclusively by dietary fibre.

8. The microbes of the human gut ferment dietary fibres that our own enzymes cannot break down, releasing short-chain fatty acids that feed the cells of the intestinal wall and help keep inflammation in check. A diet chronically poor in fibre therefore does more than deprive the body of roughage: it starves a metabolic partnership refined over millions of years. Deprived of fibre, some microbes turn to an alternative fare — the mucus that lines the gut — thinning the barrier that separates the microbial world from the body's own tissues.

In the passage, 'roughage' most nearly means:

- A)** indigestible plant material.
- B)** refined sugars.
- C)** vitamins absorbed in the colon.
- D)** coarse meat proteins.
- E)** the mucus lining of the gut.

Section B - Italian Constitution & Institutions (Q9-24)

9. How many judges sit on Italy's Constitutional Court?

- A)** 9 **B)** 12 **C)** 15 **D)** 21 **E)** 25

10. The fifteen judges of the Constitutional Court are appointed by:

- A)** the President of the Republic alone.
- B)** the President of the Republic (5), Parliament in joint session (5) and the supreme magistrature (5).
- C)** direct popular election every nine years.
- D)** the supreme courts alone.
- E)** the Parliament alone, by two-thirds majority.

11. The Italian Constitution was approved by the Constituent Assembly on 22 December 1947 and entered into force on:

- A)** 1 January 1948.
- B)** 1 May 1949.
- C)** 2 June 1946.
- D)** 18 April 1948.
- E)** 25 April 1947.

12. How many articles does the Italian Constitution contain?

- A)** 100 **B)** 114 **C)** 129 **D)** 139 **E)** 150

13. The President of the Italian Republic is elected by:

- A)** the Constitutional Court.
- B)** direct popular vote in two rounds.
- C)** the Council of Ministers.
- D)** the Chamber of Deputies alone.
- E)** Parliament meeting in joint session, integrated with delegates of the regions.

14. Italy's Parliament consists of:

- A)** the Chamber of Deputies and the Regional Councils.
- B)** two chambers — the Chamber of Deputies and the Senate of the Republic — with identical powers.
- C)** the Senate and the Council of State.
- D)** a single National Assembly.
- E)** the Chamber of Deputies and representatives of the municipalities.

- 15.** Under Article 94, the Government (Council of Ministers) must obtain the confidence of:
- A)** the Chamber of Deputies only.
 - B)** the Constitutional Court.
 - C)** the Senate only.
 - D)** both the Chamber of Deputies and the Senate.
 - E)** the President of the Republic.
- 16.** Following the 2020 constitutional cutback, first applied in the 2022 elections, the two chambers have:
- A)** 400 deputies and 200 senators.
 - B)** 400 deputies and 100 senators.
 - C)** 500 deputies and 250 senators.
 - D)** 630 deputies and 315 senators.
 - E)** 630 deputies and 200 senators.
- 17.** The Constitutional Court decides primarily on:
- A)** the legality of government contracts.
 - B)** disputes between private citizens.
 - C)** criminal appeals against convictions.
 - D)** the constitutionality of national and regional laws.
 - E)** the accession of new members to the European Union.
- 18.** Article 1 of the Constitution states that Italy is:
- A)** a constitutional monarchy.
 - B)** a democratic Republic founded on labour.
 - C)** a Republic founded on private property.
 - D)** a presidential Republic.
 - E)** a confederation of autonomous regions.
- 19.** How many of Italy's twenty regions have a special statute and autonomy?
- A)** 2 **B)** 3 **C)** 4 **D)** 5 **E)** 10
- 20.** An abrogative referendum (Article 75) is valid when:
- A)** turnout exceeds seventy-five per cent of voters.
 - B)** the President of the Republic authorises it.
 - C)** a majority of valid votes approve it AND at least half the eligible electorate turns out.
 - D)** a majority of the Chamber of Deputies passes it first.
 - E)** one third of the Senate requests it.
- 21.** The President of the Council of Ministers (the prime minister) is:
- A)** nominated by the European Council.
 - B)** the eldest senator, by automatic succession.
 - C)** elected directly by the citizens.
 - D)** chosen by the Constitutional Court.
 - E)** appointed by the President of the Republic and must hold the confidence of Parliament.
- 22.** Who has served as President of the Italian Republic since 2015 and was confirmed for a second term in 2022?
- A)** Sergio Mattarella
 - B)** Carlo Azeglio Ciampi
 - C)** Francesco Cossiga
 - D)** Sandro Pertini
 - E)** Giorgio Napolitano

23. Since October 2022, the President of the Council of Ministers has been:

- A)** Matteo Renzi
- B)** Paolo Gentiloni
- C)** Mario Draghi
- D)** Enrico Letta
- E)** Giorgia Meloni

24. Italy's national day, 2 June, commemorates:

- A)** the entry into force of the Constitution in 1948.
- B)** the 1946 referendum in which Italy chose to become a Republic.
- C)** the unification of 1861.
- D)** the March on Rome of 1922.
- E)** the liberation of 1945.

Section C - European Union (Q25-40)

25. The European Central Bank has its seat in:

- A)** Brussels.
- B)** The Hague.
- C)** Frankfurt am Main.
- D)** Paris.
- E)** Luxembourg.

26. The official seat of the European Parliament — where the twelve monthly plenary sessions are held — is:

- A)** Geneva. **B)** Strasbourg. **C)** Bonn. **D)** Luxembourg. **E)** Brussels.

27. The Court of Justice of the European Union (CJEU) sits in:

- A)** Brussels. **B)** Vienna. **C)** Luxembourg. **D)** Strasbourg. **E)** Frankfurt.

28. The European Commission is best described as:

- A)** the EU's executive arm: it proposes legislation and guards the treaties, with one member per member state.
- B)** a court hearing human-rights appeals.
- C)** the assembly of national parliament speakers.
- D)** a committee of central-bank governors.
- E)** the upper house of the EU legislature.

29. The European Council consists of:

- A)** the EU commissioners.
- B)** the foreign ministers of the member states.
- C)** all members of the European Parliament.
- D)** the heads of state or government of the member states, with its President and the Commission President.
- E)** the presidents of the national constitutional courts.

30. The Treaty of Rome (1957) established:

- A)** the North Atlantic Treaty Organization.
- B)** the Western European Union.
- C)** the Council of Europe.
- D)** the European Monetary System.
- E)** the European Economic Community (EEC).

- 31.** The Maastricht Treaty (1992) is notable for:
- A)** creating the Schengen area.
 - B)** founding the EEC.
 - C)** creating the Council of Europe.
 - D)** establishing the European Union and the path to the single currency.
 - E)** abolishing national parliaments.
- 32.** Euro banknotes and coins entered circulation on:
- A)** 1 January 2002.
 - B)** 1 January 1999.
 - C)** 1 January 2000.
 - D)** 1 January 2004.
 - E)** 1 July 2013.
- 33.** After the United Kingdom left the EU on 31 January 2020 (Brexit), the number of member states is:
- A)** 25 **B)** 26 **C)** 27 **D)** 28 **E)** 30
- 34.** Which country was the last to join the European Union, in 2013?
- A)** Romania **B)** Bulgaria **C)** Slovenia **D)** Hungary **E)** Croatia
- 35.** On 1 January 2023, Croatia:
- A)** left the Schengen area.
 - B)** adopted the euro and joined the Schengen border-free area.
 - C)** adopted the Swiss franc.
 - D)** withdrew from the European Union.
 - E)** changed its currency to the kuna.
- 36.** On 1 January 2026 Bulgaria became the 21st country to adopt the euro. Its former currency was:
- A)** the dinar **B)** the koruna **C)** the lev **D)** the forint **E)** the zloty
- 37.** The Schengen area is best described as:
- A)** the collective name for the EU's outermost regions.
 - B)** a free-trade zone limited to agriculture.
 - C)** a currency union.
 - D)** a military defence alliance.
 - E)** a group of European countries that have abolished controls at their common internal borders.
- 38.** The European Union as an organisation was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in:
- A)** 1993 **B)** 1999 **C)** 2007 **D)** 2012 **E)** 2020
- 39.** Which institution of the European Union is directly elected by the citizens?
- A)** The Court of Auditors.
 - B)** The European Parliament.
 - C)** The European Council.
 - D)** The Council of the EU.
 - E)** The European Commission.
- 40.** Which of the following EU member states does not use the euro?
- A)** Denmark **B)** Greece **C)** Spain **D)** France **E)** Portugal

Section D - Italian History (Q41-54)

- 41.** The Kingdom of Italy was proclaimed in:
- A)** 1848 **B)** 1859 **C)** 1861 **D)** 1866 **E)** 1870

- 42.** The 'Expedition of the Thousand' (1860), which conquered the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies, was led by:
- A)** Giuseppe Mazzini
 - B)** Vittorio Emanuele II
 - C)** Camillo Benso di Cavour
 - D)** Vincenzo Gioberti
 - E)** Giuseppe Garibaldi
- 43.** The prime minister of Piedmont who engineered France's support and diplomatic cover for unification was:
- A)** Camillo Benso di Cavour
 - B)** Giuseppe Garibaldi
 - C)** Giuseppe Mazzini
 - D)** Luigi Einaudi
 - E)** Francesco Crispi
- 44.** Giuseppe Mazzini is best remembered as:
- A)** the first king of united Italy.
 - B)** the ideologue of the Fascist party.
 - C)** the inventor of the electric telegraph.
 - D)** founder of the republican movement 'Young Italy' (Giovine Italia).
 - E)** Napoleon's viceroy of Italy.
- 45.** Rome became the capital of Italy in:
- A)** 1861 **B)** 1866 **C)** 1870 **D)** 1871 **E)** 1878
- 46.** Italy entered the First World War in 1915 on the side of:
- A)** the Central Powers (Germany and Austria-Hungary).
 - B)** the Triple Entente (France, Britain, Russia).
 - C)** neither — it remained neutral until 1918.
 - D)** the Ottoman Empire.
 - E)** Spain.
- 47.** The disastrous Italian defeat of October 1917 — followed by recovery and victory at Vittorio Veneto in 1918 — was the battle of:
- A)** Marengo **B)** El Alamein **C)** Custoza **D)** Lissa **E)** Caporetto
- 48.** The 'March on Rome' (October 1922) resulted in:
- A)** Mussolini being appointed Prime Minister by King Vittorio Emanuele III.
 - B)** the signing of the Lateran Pacts.
 - C)** the proclamation of the Republic.
 - D)** the abdication of the king.
 - E)** Italy's entry into the First World War.
- 49.** The Lateran Pacts of 1929 between Italy and the Holy See:
- A)** ended Italy's membership of the League of Nations.
 - B)** established the sovereign Vatican City State, ending the 'Roman Question'.
 - C)** transferred Venice to Austria.
 - D)** created the region of Trentino-Alto Adige.
 - E)** nationalised all Church property.
- 50.** Italy's Liberation Day, 25 April, marks:
- A)** the 1969 Piazza Fontana bombing.
 - B)** the 1946 institutional referendum.
 - C)** the 1945 general insurrection and liberation of Milan and Turin from Nazi-fascist occupation.
 - D)** the fall of the Berlin Wall.
 - E)** the end of the First World War.

- 51.** On 2 June 1946, Italians voted:
- A)** to restore the monarchy by a narrow margin.
 - B)** to adopt the single European currency.
 - C)** to join the North Atlantic Treaty Organization.
 - D)** for the first President of the Republic directly.
 - E)** in a referendum that founded the Republic and elected the Constituent Assembly — women voting nationally for the first time.
- 52.** Italy's post-war 'economic miracle' — rapid industrial growth, the Fiat 500, mass internal migration — occurred chiefly in the:
- A)** first decade of the 2000s.
 - B)** 1930s.
 - C)** late 1940s.
 - D)** 1950s and 1960s.
 - E)** 1980s.
- 53.** The kidnapping and murder of former Prime Minister Aldo Moro by the Red Brigades occurred in:
- A)** 1969 **B)** 1974 **C)** 1978 **D)** 1980 **E)** 1992
- 54.** The 'Mani pulite' (Clean Hands) judicial investigations opened in 1992 and:
- A)** investigated doping in professional football.
 - B)** exposed systemic bribery ('Tangentopoli'), dissolving the party system of the 'First Republic'.
 - C)** nationalised the major banks.
 - D)** prosecuted Nazi war criminals.
 - E)** rewrote the constitution's labour articles.

Section E - Art, Architecture & Heritage (Q55-66)

- 55.** Leonardo da Vinci's Last Supper is a mural painted in:
- A)** the refectory of Santa Maria delle Grazie, Milan.
 - B)** the Louvre, Paris.
 - C)** the Uffizi Gallery, Florence.
 - D)** St Peter's Basilica, Rome.
 - E)** the Sistine Chapel, Vatican City.
- 56.** Michelangelo's David (1501-04) stands today in:
- A)** the Louvre, Paris.
 - B)** the Boboli Gardens.
 - C)** the Galleria dell'Accademia, Florence.
 - D)** the Uffizi Gallery.
 - E)** the Vatican Museums.
- 57.** Michelangelo's Pietà (1499), the only work he ever signed, is in:
- A)** St Peter's Basilica, Rome.
 - B)** the Galleria dell'Accademia, Florence.
 - C)** the Prado, Madrid.
 - D)** Milan Cathedral.
 - E)** Florence Cathedral.
- 58.** Raphael's The School of Athens is frescoed in:
- A)** the Sistine Chapel.
 - B)** the Stanza della Segnatura of the Vatican Apostolic Palace.
 - C)** the Uffizi Gallery, Florence.
 - D)** the Scrovegni Chapel, Padua.
 - E)** the Doge's Palace, Venice.

- 59.** Botticelli's *The Birth of Venus* hangs in:
- A)** the Vatican Pinacoteca.
 - B)** the National Gallery, London.
 - C)** the Galleria Borghese, Rome.
 - D)** the Uffizi Gallery, Florence.
 - E)** the Louvre, Paris.
- 60.** The ceiling of the Sistine Chapel was painted by Michelangelo between:
- A)** 1450 and 1455. **B)** 1490 and 1495. **C)** 1508 and 1512. **D)** 1536 and 1541. **E)** 1575 and 1580.
- 61.** Filippo Brunelleschi's masterpiece of engineering is:
- A)** St Mark's Campanile, Venice.
 - B)** the Baths of Caracalla.
 - C)** the dome of St Paul's Cathedral, London.
 - D)** the Leaning Tower of Pisa.
 - E)** the double-shell dome of Florence Cathedral (Santa Maria del Fiore).
- 62.** The Pantheon in Rome — still the world's largest unreinforced concrete dome — was essentially completed under the emperor:
- A)** Hadrian **B)** Nero **C)** Constantine **D)** Augustus **E)** Trajan
- 63.** The Colosseum — properly the Flavian Amphitheatre — was inaugurated in:
- A)** 44 BC **B)** 72 BC **C)** 80 AD **D)** 315 AD **E)** 500 AD
- 64.** Caravaggio's revolutionary painting style is characterised by:
- A)** pastel colours and loose impressionist brushwork.
 - B)** geometric cubist fragmentation.
 - C)** serene neoclassical balance.
 - D)** gold-ground Byzantine flatness.
 - E)** dramatic contrasts of light and dark with unsparing realism.
- 65.** Gian Lorenzo Bernini, the leading sculptor-architect of the Roman Baroque, created:
- A)** the dome of Florence Cathedral.
 - B)** the colonnade of St Peter's Square and *The Ecstasy of Saint Teresa*.
 - C)** the *David* in the Accademia.
 - D)** the frescoes of the Scrovegni Chapel.
 - E)** *The Birth of Venus*.
- 66.** The archaeological site of Pompeii was buried — and thus preserved — by:
- A)** medieval urban renewal.
 - B)** Allied bombing in 1943.
 - C)** the 1908 Messina earthquake.
 - D)** the eruption of Vesuvius in 79 AD.
 - E)** flooding of the Tiber in antiquity.

Section F - Literature, Philosophy & Ideas (Q67-80)

- 67.** Dante's *Divine Comedy*:
- A)** runs to 100 cantos across three canticles — *Inferno*, *Purgatorio*, *Paradiso* — in vernacular Tuscan.
 - B)** was composed after the Council of Trent.
 - C)** is a collection of 100 sonnets.
 - D)** is written throughout in Latin.
 - E)** avoids any religious or political content.

- 68.** Boccaccio's Decameron is framed as:
- A)** a single narrator's deathbed confession.
 - B)** a guided dream-tour of the afterlife.
 - C)** an exchange of letters between two lovers.
 - D)** ten young Florentines telling ten stories each over ten days while plague ravages the city.
 - E)** a debate among seven saints.
- 69.** Petrarch, author of the Canzoniere addressed to Laura, is traditionally called:
- A)** the father of scientific history.
 - B)** the father of Humanism.
 - C)** the poet of the Risorgimento.
 - D)** the father of experimental medicine.
 - E)** the father of Italian opera.
- 70.** The Prince (1513) — which argues it is safer for a ruler to be feared than loved — was written by:
- A)** Dante Alighieri
 - B)** Erasmus of Rotterdam
 - C)** Thomas More
 - D)** Baldassare Castiglione
 - E)** Niccolò Machiavelli
- 71.** Alessandro Manzoni's novel The Betrothed (I promessi sposi) is set:
- A)** in Fascist-era Rome.
 - B)** in seventeenth-century Lombardy, amid war, famine and the plague of Milan.
 - C)** in the decades of the Risorgimento.
 - D)** during the Roman Republic of 1849.
 - E)** in medieval Sicily.
- 72.** The Name of the Rose (1980), a murder mystery set in a fourteenth-century Italian monastery, was written by:
- A)** Elsa Morante **B)** Primo Levi **C)** Grazia Deledda **D)** Umberto Eco **E)** Italo Calvino
- 73.** The 1934 Nobel Prize in Literature went to the Italian dramatist of Six Characters in Search of an Author:
- A)** Dario Fo
 - B)** Alberto Moravia
 - C)** Luigi Pirandello
 - D)** Gabriele D'Annunzio
 - E)** Eugenio Montale
- 74.** If This Is a Man (Se questo è un uomo), the testament of Auschwitz by a deported Jewish chemist, was written by:
- A)** Primo Levi
 - B)** Curzio Malaparte
 - C)** Giorgio Bassani
 - D)** Natalia Ginzburg
 - E)** Cesare Pavese
- 75.** Invisible Cities — in which Marco Polo describes impossible cities to Kublai Khan — is by:
- A)** Umberto Eco
 - B)** Luigi Pirandello
 - C)** Giuseppe Tomasi di Lampedusa
 - D)** Federico Tozzi
 - E)** Italo Calvino

- 76.** The Neapolitan Novels, beginning with *My Brilliant Friend*, are published under the pseudonym:
- A)** Oriana Fallaci
 - B)** Dacia Maraini
 - C)** Elena Ferrante
 - D)** Susanna Tamaro
 - E)** Natalia Ginzburg
- 77.** Plato's allegory of the cave appears in:
- A)** Virgil's *Aeneid*.
 - B)** The Symposium.
 - C)** The Phaedo.
 - D)** The Nicomachean Ethics.
 - E)** The Republic (Book VII).
- 78.** Galileo's *Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems* (1632) brought him:
- A)** exile to England, where the book was burned.
 - B)** a papal pension and a cardinal's hat.
 - C)** the discovery of Jupiter's moons.
 - D)** trial and condemnation in 1633 for defending Copernican heliocentrism.
 - E)** the abolition of the Roman Inquisition.
- 79.** 'Man is born free, and everywhere he is in chains' opens:
- A)** Rousseau's *The Social Contract*.
 - B)** Kant's *Critique of Pure Reason*.
 - C)** Locke's *Two Treatises of Government*.
 - D)** Hobbes's *Leviathan*.
 - E)** Voltaire's *Candide*.
- 80.** *One Hundred Years of Solitude*, the masterpiece of Latin-American magical realism, is by:
- A)** Isabel Allende
 - B)** Gabriel García Márquez
 - C)** Jorge Luis Borges
 - D)** Julio Cortázar
 - E)** Mario Vargas Llosa

Section G - Science, Technology & Society (Q81-90)

- 81.** Guglielmo Marconi shared the 1909 Nobel Prize in Physics for:
- A)** wireless telegraphy — the basis of radio.
 - B)** the transmission of speech by telephone.
 - C)** the first controlled nuclear fission.
 - D)** the discovery of the transistor.
 - E)** the invention of the electric battery.
- 82.** Alessandro Volta (1745–1827) is celebrated for:
- A)** devising the periodic table.
 - B)** discovering X-rays.
 - C)** discovering the planet Neptune.
 - D)** inventing the electric battery — the 'voltaic pile' — in 1800.
 - E)** the first transatlantic radio signal.
- 83.** Enrico Fermi's team achieved the first controlled nuclear chain reaction on 2 December 1942 at:
- A)** the Oak Ridge complex.
 - B)** CERN, Geneva.
 - C)** Los Alamos.
 - D)** the Via Panisperna institute, Rome.
 - E)** the University of Chicago.

- 84.** CERN, the European laboratory that runs the Large Hadron Collider, is located near:
A) Turin. **B)** Geneva. **C)** Paris. **D)** Vienna. **E)** Munich.
- 85.** With his improved telescope in 1610, Galileo discovered:
A) the canals of Mars.
B) the planet Neptune.
C) the four largest moons of Jupiter.
D) the Antarctic ozone hole.
E) Halley's Comet.
- 86.** Avogadro's law states that equal volumes of gases at the same temperature and pressure:
A) exert no pressure on their containers.
B) contain equal numbers of atoms only.
C) contain equal numbers of molecules.
D) have equal mass.
E) must both be noble gases.
- 87.** Alexander Fleming's 1928 discovery, later mass-produced for D-Day, was:
A) insulin.
B) penicillin.
C) the polio vaccine.
D) aspirin.
E) chloroquine.
- 88.** The double-helix structure of DNA (1953) was chiefly worked out by:
A) Watson and Crick, building crucially on Rosalind Franklin's X-ray data.
B) Hershey and Chase.
C) Linus Pauling working alone.
D) Mendel and Darwin together.
E) Chargaff and Griffith.
- 89.** The 2024 Nobel Prize in Physics was awarded to John Hopfield and Geoffrey Hinton for:
A) high-temperature superconductivity.
B) the invention of the blue LED.
C) the discovery of the Higgs boson.
D) the detection of gravitational waves.
E) foundational discoveries in artificial neural networks and machine learning.
- 90.** The James Webb Space Telescope, launched on 25 December 2021, observes primarily in:
A) gamma rays.
B) radio waves.
C) ultraviolet only.
D) the infrared.
E) visible light.

Section H - Current Affairs 2024 (Q91-100)

- 91.** Following the death of Pope Francis in April 2025, the conclave of 8 May 2025 elected:
A) Cardinal Matteo Zuppi as John Paul III.
B) Cardinal Pietro Parolin as Benedict XVIII.
C) Cardinal Luis Tagle as Pius XIII.
D) Cardinal Péter Erdő as Paul VII.
E) Cardinal Robert Francis Prevost — Leo XIV, the first American pope.

- 92.** The 2026 Winter Olympics (6–22 February 2026) were hosted by:
- A)** Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo.
 - B)** Oslo.
 - C)** Turin alone.
 - D)** Sapporo.
 - E)** Innsbruck.
- 93.** The 2026 FIFA World Cup — the first 48-team edition, hosted by the USA, Canada and Mexico — was won by:
- A)** Argentina, beating France.
 - B)** Portugal, beating England.
 - C)** Brazil, beating Germany.
 - D)** Spain, beating Argentina 1–0 after extra time.
 - E)** France, beating Portugal.
- 94.** After the Paris 2024 Summer Games — the city's third Olympics — the next Summer Olympics will be held in:
- A)** Tokyo in 2030.
 - B)** Los Angeles in 2028.
 - C)** Rio de Janeiro in 2026.
 - D)** Madrid in 2027.
 - E)** Berlin in 2029.
- 95.** The 2025 Nobel Peace Prize was awarded to:
- A)** the World Health Organization.
 - B)** Nihon Hidankyo, Japan's atomic-bomb survivors.
 - C)** María Corina Machado, Venezuelan opposition leader.
 - D)** Volodymyr Zelensky.
 - E)** the International Atomic Energy Agency.
- 96.** The 2024 Nobel Prize in Literature was awarded to:
- A)** Jon Fosse.
 - B)** László Krasznahorkai.
 - C)** Annie Ernaux.
 - D)** Kazuo Ishiguro.
 - E)** Han Kang — the first South Korean laureate.
- 97.** Following the November 2024 US election, the president inaugurated on 20 January 2025 was:
- A)** Ron DeSantis.
 - B)** Donald Trump — the 47th president, in a second, non-consecutive term.
 - C)** Barack Obama, in an unprecedented third term.
 - D)** Joe Biden, for a second term.
 - E)** Kamala Harris, the first woman president.
- 98.** The Catholic Jubilee (Holy Year) that ran through 2025 under the motto 'Pilgrims of Hope' was centred on:
- A)** Mexico City. **B)** Jerusalem. **C)** Lourdes. **D)** Rome. **E)** Assisi.
- 99.** The 2025 Nobel Prize in Physics honoured work on macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit — the foundation of:
- A)** superconducting quantum computers.
 - B)** mRNA vaccines.
 - C)** nuclear fusion reactors.
 - D)** satellite navigation.
 - E)** perovskite solar panels.

- 100.** The 2025 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded for discoveries concerning:
- A)** messenger-RNA vaccines.
 - B)** the hepatitis C virus.
 - C)** regulatory T cells and the FOXP3 gene.
 - D)** microRNAs.
 - E)** the CRISPR genetic scissors.

Answer key

This key refers to the option order printed in this paper. The online app shuffles option order on every attempt, so answer letters inside the app will differ from the ones here.

1	B	2	E	3	D	4	C	5	A
6	E	7	C	8	A	9	C	10	B
11	A	12	D	13	E	14	B	15	D
16	A	17	D	18	B	19	D	20	C
21	E	22	A	23	E	24	B	25	C
26	B	27	C	28	A	29	D	30	E
31	D	32	A	33	C	34	E	35	B
36	C	37	E	38	D	39	B	40	A
41	C	42	E	43	A	44	D	45	D
46	B	47	E	48	A	49	B	50	C
51	E	52	D	53	C	54	B	55	A
56	C	57	A	58	B	59	D	60	C
61	E	62	A	63	C	64	E	65	B
66	D	67	A	68	D	69	B	70	E
71	B	72	D	73	C	74	A	75	E
76	C	77	E	78	D	79	A	80	B
81	A	82	D	83	E	84	B	85	C
86	C	87	B	88	A	89	E	90	D
91	E	92	A	93	D	94	B	95	C
96	E	97	B	98	D	99	A	100	C